The fog of war is denser than ever. We only know that IDF ground forces are fighting in the heart of Gaza City, near Al-Shifa Hospital. Ironically, the hospital was built by Israeli architects in the 1970s, when Israel was occupying Gaza. But the tunnels below the hospital were not built by Israel. We do not know whether the fighting has reached the tunnels.

That Israel's war against Hamas has to take place in a densely populated urban setting, with countless innocent victims, is highly distressing. That Hamas is using the civilian setting and constantly broadcasting Israel's inhuman behavior is in line with its strategy from the very outset. That Israel has decided to pursue a campaign, the aim of which is to destroy Hamas's ability to repeat its attack of October 7, is evident. That the majority of public opinion in the West willfully ignores this justification and turns against Israel is hard to take. That the Israeli ambassador to the United Nations found it necessary to wear the yellow star of Nazi times on his coat is plain stupid, as it ignores the difference between then and now.

There seems to be some divergence of opinion within the Israeli war cabinet. While Defense Minister Gallant announced that there was no way of interrupting the fighting, Minister Gantz declared that every effort would be made to hasten the release of the hostages, either by military or political means. It was later confirmed that Gantz had suggested holding a joint press conference, but Netanyahu refused. Thus Gantz and Gallant each held separate press conferences while the PM spoke without journalists being present and, as usual, offered only a general declaration about the necessity for Israel to control the security situation in Gaza for an indeterminate period after the war. That is the national unity of our war cabinet.

Wednesday, November 8

Whereas the two fanatics, Smotrich and Ben-Gvir, demand more extreme measures against the Palestinians of the West Bank, the members of the war